

MINUTES
VANCE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS
WORK SESSION
March 17, 2025

The Vance County Board of Commissioners held a work session on Monday, March 17, 2025 at 4:00 p.m. in the Commissioners' Conference Room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia Perry.

Absent: Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster and Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom.

Fleet Management. The first item on the agenda was a presentation from Enterprise Fleet Management. Mr. Max Greenblatt provided a proposal to the board for the management of the county's vehicles. He stated that by partnering with Enterprise, the county will be better able to leverage its buying power, implement a tighter controlled resale program to lower total cost of ownership, and in turn, minimize operational spending. He stated that the county can reduce fuel costs by 21% and reduce maintenance costs from \$153 on average to \$76 per unit. Leveraging an open-ended lease maximizes cash flow and recognizes equity from vehicles at an average of 10% above Black Book value. By shifting from reactively replacing inoperable vehicles to proactively planning vehicle purchases, the county will be able to replace all of its vehicles over the course of five years while creating a sustainable savings of \$104,462. He provided information on a proposed structure, the county's fleet profile and replacement schedule, maintenance and fuel telematics, budget impacts, etc.

Following discussion and a few questions from the board, Commissioner Dan Brummitt requested a breakdown of vehicles by department. Mr. Greenblatt stated that he would pull that information together. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that the board will need to take formal action on this matter at its April regular meeting. The board thanked Mr. Greenblatt for his presentation.

Online Committee Meetings. Ms. Perry informed the board that she had received a request from a citizen to stream committee meetings online. She noted that the administrative conference room is not conducive to streaming online and would also put a strain on IT staff who would need to be present during all committee meetings. She recommended moving all committee meetings to work sessions which are held in the commissioners' conference room. This matter was referred to the Technology Committee for further review.

Robert's Rules of Order. Ms. Perry noted that Commissioner Valencia Perry has questioned whether or not the board has ever considered adopting Robert's Rules of Order. Attorney Jonathan S. Care stated that counties typically do not adopt Robert's Rules of Order because it can tie the board with technicalities.

Social Media Policy for Commissioners and Board Appointees to County Boards and Committees. Ms. Perry informed the board that Mayor Melissa Elliott has asked if the county has a social media policy for commissioners and individuals appointed to county boards and committees. She stated that if the board would like staff to research this, it could be done after budget season. Attorney Care stated that if the board wishes to adopt a policy, he recommended a policy which states that commissioners and board appointees do not speak on behalf of the county. Chair Faines agreed with this recommendation. Ms. Perry stated that she would consult with Attorney Care to have a policy drafted.

Nutrition Program. Ms. Perry noted that Green Rural Redevelopment Organization (GRRO) has received a grant to assist 900 households with food insecurities (Medicaid recipients). They have requested the county's support of the program and would like the Department of Social Services to help in identifying households in need. Commissioner Dan Brummitt expressed his concern with releasing names of individuals for privacy reasons. Attorney Care stated that his concern is the perception of favoritism to GRRO and questioned exactly what they are asking for as far as support from the county. Ms. Perry stated that she would contact GRRO and request more detailed information.

Youth Services Use of Eaton Johnson Gym – MOU. Ms. Perry asked for direction from the board on allowable uses of the Eaton Johnson gym by Youth Services and the Henderson-Vance Recreation Department. She noted that Youth Services is 100% county funded, and the county provides their office space at Eaton Johnson. She stated that the city has been using the gym the same way it uses the Aycock Recreation Center by renting the facility for various events. Since Eaton Johnson is not a shared city/county facility, she recommended an MOU be drafted between the county and city for the use of the gym.

The board discussed this matter and was not in favor of the facility being rented out. It should only be used for Youth Services and Recreation programs. Youth Services should also be responsible for cleaning the gym and adjacent restrooms. Ms. Perry stated that she would begin working on an MOU to bring back to the board for review.

Additional County Water Lines. Ms. Perry informed the board that she had been contacted by a business owner on Industry Drive who asked if county water would ever be available to them. Commissioner Brummitt responded that the city provides water in this area and the county is not allowed to have water lines within a certain distance of city lines.

2010 Phase 1B Water Contracts/Signups. Special Projects Coordinator Frankie Nobles reported that he has received several calls from residents who signed up for water in 2010 stating that they no longer want county water. He asked for direction from the board on this matter. Attorney Care recommended that the county ask for a written request from these residents stating that they no longer desire the water tap and would like to receive a refund of their deposit. The board was in favor of this recommendation.

Mr. Nobles informed the board that a community meeting is scheduled for Thursday, April 24 at 7:00 p.m. at the Kittrell Community Center to inform residents of the project and to answer any questions residents may have.

Affordable Housing. Ms. Perry informed the board that Sherenia Branche with Branche & Associates reached out to her about partnering with the county and begin conversations related to educating the public on affordable housing in the county. Ms. Perry suggested that the Housing Authority be involved if the board wishes to begin these conversations. There was no direction given on this matter.

Gun Control in County. Ms. Perry noted that during the board's March meeting, a resident requested that the board create an ordinance that would prohibit the firing of a weapon within 100 yards of a dwelling. Sheriff Curtis Brame stated that the board needs to be cautious when deciding on this matter because you do not want to take away anyone's 2nd Amendment right. He also stated that he is not aware of any county that has an ordinance of this nature. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones stated that Edgecombe County developed an ordinance in 2021 with restrictions.

The board discussed this matter and was not in favor of developing an ordinance prohibiting the firing of a weapon within 100 yards of a dwelling.

Community Project Funding (CPF) Request. Ms. Perry stated that the assistant city manager had presented to her a letter from the former county manager to Congressman Don Davis dated March 2023 in support of the CPF request seeking grant assistance related to construction of a communications tower to meet both the city and county's emergency communication needs. She asked if the board was aware of this and noted that \$2.1M has been appropriated to the city for this purpose.

Commissioner Brummitt stated that there were informal conversations with the city about possibly constructing a new tower close to city limits to enhance in-building coverage within the city. He stated that the county wanted to make sure a new tower would work with our existing tower, but the conversations did not go much further than that. Ms. Perry stated that she would research and contact the city for more information.

As there was no further business, at 5:30 p.m., the work session was adjourned.